

although this is less of a problem in an outdoor pool. Try not to swallow the water. If you do, drink fresh water after your swim. Shower thoroughly afterward. Swimming has great benefits during pregnancy. It has a low risk of injury while providing a good cardiovascular workout and improving muscle tone, so don't be put off by unnecessary worries.

Is it OK to use nicotine patches or gum while I'm pregnant?

Nicotine is known to decrease the blood supply to the fetus. This could affect the baby's growth, especially in early pregnancy. Although tobacco substitutes such as patches, gum, and lozenges deliver less nicotine to your body than smoking, you should never use them without a doctor's advice. Ask your doctor for information on safer ways to beat cigarette and nicotine cravings.